

MINUTES

The Evaluation Subcommittee Meeting: April 27, 2023

The meeting was held remotely via Zoom and viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 15 and Verizon Channel 45 starting at 5:00 p.m.

In Attendance: Member Hays (Chair), Member Graham, Member McLaughlin | **Roll Call:** 3/0

Central Administration: Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Joan Bowen, Suzanne Galusi (unconfirmed), Dr. Peter Cushing (unconfirmed)

Members of the Public: *unknown*

MEMORANDUM

As approved by the School Committee on February 1, 2023 (2023-3): it is agreed the Evaluation Subcommittee will meet to review and develop the process for the 2022-2023 Superintendent Evaluation.

AGENDA

As approved by the Evaluation Subcommittee on Thursday February 16, 2023, the Evaluation Subcommittee will meet to: Finalize the template design and instructions

Member Hays provides a brief synopsis of the previous meeting, where the evaluation tool that DESE provides was reviewed, discussed and evaluated for use this year. There was a question of whether it might be difficult to see the focus indicators selected for this year that people should be rating. Member Hays shares her screen and scrolls to Page 3, where the Superintendent's goals were filled in and the highlighted focus indicators that were selected to accompany those goals.

Member McLaughlin looks for clarification on the Superintendent's Performance Goals and Member Hays confirms the Description is completed according to the data provided by the Superintendent, for her goals. Also would like to have a sheet that just gives the committee instructions for goals previously identified by the Superintendent. She continues to inquire if, "there is anything that identifies this is Medford"?

Member Hays points out the name of the Superintendent is at the top of the document, (Page 1) along with the relative instruction details (Page 3). There is no way to add to or change the basic form itself to include Medford Public Schools. The signature line is not available to be utilized.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent suggests adding after her name, the wording 'Medford'.

Member Hays shares that this document is going to live on the Medford website and be sent to DESE and the fillable box is not allowing her to go any further with more text. Next step will be to identify how the document lives on the Medford Public Schools website so the community has access to it.

Member McLaughlin goes back to the highlighted pieces. Likes the highlighted portions. She is assuming a one-page sheet of instruction for the school committee colleagues would be helpful to have a brief explanation.

Member Hays confirms this was sent to subcommittee members the previous evening. She shares the Step-by-Step Instruction Template. She has the mentioned 'materials needed' in a folder and will send them to everyone so they have what is needed in hand.

Member Graham has no questions - thinks it looks great.

Member McLaughlin would like to see in the heading, the text, Superintendent End-of-Cycle Summative Evaluation'.

Member Hays adjusts the text to reflect the request and scrolls through the document.

Member McLaughlin reflects on the wording 'Comments' and inquires as to when this is going to be discussed. She goes on to point out that it is spoken to in #5 and suggests to the subcommittee to add a narrative that indicates how comments that are inclusive will be condensed and what the process will be. This is an overall committee evaluation and recommends not making comments personal and not using first-person reference. Would like to hear feedback from others and does think this is part of the Agenda today in #5. She thinks there should be a 5a.

Member Hays agrees, however personally feels that if the narrative gets too directive about how comments are to be worded, we are undermining the professionalism of our colleagues as to how a particular member chooses to word their comments.

Member McLaughlin points out that when people are doing the summative, the 'I' statements cannot be used and wants to know how the comments are summarized on all of the different categories. She is asking what the process is for summarizing the individual comments to make them cohesive.' Points out this was an issue last time and the qualitative data wasn't cohesive and it wasn't a narrative.

Member Hays shares that in looking at other cities and towns, she has seen it done any number of ways. She has seen where members' comments have been dumped in. She has seen others where they were created either by the chairperson of the committee, who was the one doing the final composite, or whether it was a subcommittee. She has seen others where a narrative was created based on the comments. It could go either way. She believes the intention is that the subcommittee is going to do that and create the composite before taking it back to the full committee, where they will have their opportunity to comment on and change anything that may have been miscommunicated something, or if their comments were used or included that they didn't want to put in. She was considering putting somewhere in the instructions, if there is a particular comment that someone feels is most important to be included, that there is a way to highlight this somehow. She would like to know how others feel about this.

Member McLaughlin wants to figure out if it will be a total text dump where everybody's comments get put into the overall evaluation or are we summarizing the comments. She thinks the subcommittee can do that and it's part of what has been suggested and the overall committee reviews and approves. The process needs to be clear and time needs to be scheduled to be able to do this, especially if people are explicitly being asked to make comments. In the past, some people added more, some less and some did little to none. She wants to be clear and is leaning towards creating a narrative that would be inclusive.

Member Graham believes that the committee should take the approach for 3 or 4 things, say: 'representative comments (from the committee) include' and a couple of bullets where verbatim comments various members have said. We are going to send everybody detailed comments where there is the opportunity to pick the gamut of feedback without saying the same thing 3 times.

Member Hays asks if it is a narrative plus the comments?

Member Graham no - just the comments.

Member Hays confirms including text that will include 'representative comments'

Member McLaughlin what she heard Member Graham say, following representative comments of the evaluation and being as inclusive as possible. She's okay with both.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent confirms and agrees with what everyone is saying.

Member Hays adds under point #5: The subcommittee will select representative comments for the final evaluation.

Member McLaughlin wants to check on the next meeting to make sure it is in her calendar.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent confirms May 8, 2023 is the Subcommittee meeting where she will be presenting with artifacts and links, (in her presentation) to all.

Member McLaughlin corrects her that the meeting is a Committee of the Whole and points out the following Subcommittee meeting is on the 22 May 2023.

Member Hays states, the deadline to return to us (the evaluation) ...

Member McLaughlin asks if the subcommittee is getting 'this' to them (the school committee), this Monday or the 8th May.

Member McLaughlin corrects her that the committee will receive it and it will be talked about on the 8th May 2023.

Member Hays adds the date to the header of Item #4: Individual members rate overall performance. Individual evaluations are due to Member Hays by May 21, 2023. Asks if there are any other comments to today's agenda.

Member McLaughlin thanks and acknowledges the work Member Hays did.

Motion to approve and place on the May 15th Agenda for full school committee approval by Member Graham; seconded by Member McLaughlin.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent looks for clarification and confirmation - points out the minutes are on the Agenda for May 1 (to be approved) because if she is presenting on May 8, 2023 to the Subcommittee meeting, and the (full) committee approves this (the minutes) by the 1st in order for it (the evaluation

composite) to be used on the 8th. The minutes are already on the Agenda for Monday, so the Subcommittee will be able to report out on this meeting on Monday May 1, 2023.

Member Graham points out that there will have to be a Motion to Approve this process on Monday (May 1, 2023) as well and requests an update to the Agenda to put a Motion to Approve under the Subcommittee report to be voted on.

Member McLaughlin looks for confirmation on what Member Graham is saying; states that a Motion to Approve can be made on the floor.

Motion to approve and place on the May 15th Agenda for full school committee approval by Member Graham; seconded by Member McLaughlin is withdrawn.

Superintendent Edouard-Vincent looks for clarification and confirmation if this (Motion) should reside under New Business or under the Minutes.

Member Graham confirms this should be under the Minutes section.

Motion to Approve the Template and Process and placed on the May 1st 2023 School Committee Agenda for consideration, by Member Graham; seconded by Member McLaughlin
Motion carries 3/0

Motion to Adjourn by Member McLaughlin; seconded by Member Graham.
Motion Carries 3/0

Meeting Adjourns: 5:33p